

Question 56 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Analyse how the choice among on-the-job, off-the-job, and e-learning methods can affect training outcomes.

Introduction

Method choice affects learning quality, transfer, cost, motivation and therefore Kirkpatrick outcomes. Analyse each method's outcome pattern and the idea of fit.

Detailed points

- 1. OJT outcome pattern.** Strong transfer and relevance (good level 3 if coaching is skilled). Weak if the coach is busy or teaches wrong methods — then outcomes are bad habits at scale.
- 2. Off-the-job outcome pattern.** Better conceptual learning and safe practice (level 2). Level 3 suffers if work does not resemble the classroom. High cost may be justified for dangerous or new skills.
- 3. E-learning outcome pattern.** Consistent knowledge, tracking, scale (good for level 2 information). Weak completion, isolation, or poor design destroy even level 1–2. Interpersonal skills usually need extra live practice.
- 4. Fit to objective.** Motor skill → OJT/simulation; interpersonal → role play; information update → e-learning. Wrong fit lowers outcomes regardless of budget.
- 5. Learner factors.** New employees may need structured off-the-job; experienced staff may prefer OJT or micro e-learning. Mismatch reduces motivation and learning.
- 6. Blended outcomes.** Combining methods often beats any single method: concept + practice + job support.
- 7. Climate interaction.** Any method fails if workplace punishes new behaviour. Method analysis must include transfer context.
- 8. Analytical point.** Outcomes are not determined by the label 'OJT' or 'e-learning' but by fit, quality of execution, and support. Choice is a strategic HRD decision.

Conclusion. Analyse each method's typical strengths/failures, then fit, blend, and climate. Method choice shapes whether training stays in the head or appears in job performance.